Today
Welcome to your next lesson: Welcome to HIST200!

I'm preparing your personalized lesson based on what you've learned, what's next, and the best ways to help you grow.

Step by step, you’re moving forward.

Let’s zoom out and look at what HIST200 will do for you, Ron 🔭

This course is about American history since World War II, but not as a pile of dates and names. You’ll use a systems-thinking lens:

You’ll study how decisions, constraints, institutions, and tradeoffs created the world you live in today — your tech, your politics, your economy, your daily life.

So instead of “What year did X happen?”, you’ll ask things like:
Who decided this? What pressures were they under? What did it set in motion decades later?

Here’s the simple structure of the course 📚

The course has 2 units, and each unit is one week long:

Unit 1: The atomic age and the rise of technological America: 1945 to 1970

Big picture: postwar power, fear, prosperity, technology, and institutions.
You’ll connect this era to how modern technological America starts to take shape.
Unit 2: The United States in a new era: 1970 to today

Big picture: a more market-oriented, networked, globalized,

and security-focused America.
You'll connect this to things that feel very current: networks, markets, global links, and security concerns.
Think of these topic labels as a roadmap, not content you need to know yet. We'll explore them step by step later, not in this orientation.

How you'll be graded 

There are two main reviews plus weekly discussions and possible bonus points:

Unit 1 Review

Worth 30% of your course grade.
Not timed.
Unlimited retakes.
Purpose: make sure you really "get" the big ideas from 1945–1970 before moving on.
Final Unit Review (covers the full course, especially Unit 2)

Worth 60% of your course grade.
Timed.
You get only one retake if you're not happy with your first attempt.
Weekly Discussions

Worth 10% of your grade.
Based on your participation every week in the Discussions area until your term's end date.
This is where you'll react, debate, and connect history to today in short posts.
Bonus Points

You can earn up to 10 bonus points total.
You get them by submitting and passing all reviews on time.
All reviews are multiple-choice only, focused on:

Major ideas
Patterns and themes
Tradeoffs and constraints
Cause and effect
Long-term historical consequences
No trick questions — it's about your understanding, not memorization.

You've now got everything you need for this orientation

lesson:

You know what HIST200 is about
You know the two-unit structure and what each week roughly covers
You understand how reviews, discussions, and bonus points work
You're all set to move to the next lesson 🎯
If anything about structure or grading feels unclear later, you can always ask me again — or check with Student Services for official details.